

Best Congress or Conference < 500

Delegates

Awarded to a congress or conference of less than 500 attendees that best advances the aims of the organising body, provides outstanding communication, builds relationships and provides an outstanding experience and engagement for attendees.

Eligibility Requirements

Entries in this Category must adhere to the following rules to be considered for an Australian Event Award:

1. The event must have taken place wholly between July 1, 2025 and June 30, 2026 or, in the case that part of the event falls inside and part outside of these dates, the entrant must contact The Event Awards for a ruling from the Judging Panel on whether they are eligible to enter in a particular year.
2. The event must be a congress or conference with less than 500 delegates.
3. The event is either:
 - a. a live or hybrid event which has taken place in Australia with an audience attendance at the physical event; or
 - b. a broadcast (including online) event which was created, managed, packaged and initiated in Australia. (For the avoidance of doubt, international broadcast platform suppliers can be used, but the broadcast must have been initiated in Australia).
4. The event must have been principally organised by people who are Australian Citizens or Permanent Residents of Australia.
5. The entrant must be either:
 - a. The owner of the event or events; OR
 - b. A product or service provider to the event or events with permission of the event owner to enter the event for an Australian Event Award

Judging Criteria

The judges will score each entry against the following criteria:

1. Quality of the Event
 - a. Degree to which the quality of the event achieves industry excellence (25%)
 - b. Degree to which stakeholder needs were identified and met (10%)
 - c. Degree of innovation, uniqueness and/or creativity (25%)
 - d. Quality of communication and promotion (10%)
2. Management Processes (10%)
3. Degree of Difficulty (10%)
4. Evidence to Support Claims (10%)

Entry Form Questions

The entry form for this category contains the following questions:

- Save your entry often to minimise the risk of data loss. We recommend saving after you enter each question and after each image upload.
- Please upload images and videos one at a time, saving after each one.
- Your information is not saved or uploaded until you click the SAVE button at the bottom of this page. If you experience computer or internet problems without saving your data will be lost.
- All content which forms part of your entry must be written in full on this form. *(For clarity, links to external pages or videos will NOT be reviewed or assessed as part of your entry by the judges. Formatting, including tables, bullet points, fonts are not accepted in entries.)*

SECTION 1 - Eligibility Requirements Check

(Note: You must be able to answer 'Confirmed' to all questions in order for this entry to be eligible.)

1. The event took place between 1 July 2025 and 30 June 2026, or I have written confirmation from the Australian Event Awards to enter this year
2. The event was a congress or conference with less than 500 delegates
3. The event was either:
 - a. a live or hybrid event which took place in Australia with an audience attendance at the physical event; or
 - b. a broadcast (including online) event which was created, managed, packaged and initiated in Australia
4. The event was principally organised by people who are Australian Citizens or Permanent Residents of Australia
5. The entrant is either the owner of the event or events or a product or service provider to the event or events with permission of the event owner to enter the event for an Australian Event Award

SECTION 2 - Entrant Information

6. Confirm that the Entrant stipulated above is financially solvent as at 16 July 2026 and is expected to remain financially viable for the next 12 months.
7. If your answer to the question above is 'no', please explain this situation. *(We understand that sometimes events are staged by organisations that are not going concerns. If this is the case, please explain why.)*

SECTION 3 - Event Details

8. Provide the name of the event.
9. Provide the event start and finish date. *(The event must have taken place between 1 July 2025 and 30 June 2026. If your event overlaps 30 June, please contact us to discuss which year is the appropriate entry year.)*
10. In which states or territories did the event take place?
11. Where (venues, cities) did the event take place?
12. Is your event a public event? *(A public event is any event available to the public. It can be a free or ticketed event but must be available for anyone to attend. Note: Your answer does not affect the judging of your entry.)*
13. Submit a photograph or image that supports the entry. *(jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
14. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.

15. Submit a second photograph or image that supports the entry. (*jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.*)
16. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
17. Submit a third photograph or image that supports the entry. (*jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.*)
18. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
19. Optionally, submit a video (maximum 3 mins) to support the entry. (*Online video submissions must be in mpeg, mp4, mov, avi or wmv format. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.*)
20. If you have a client, briefly describe the client relationship. (Include how many years you have worked with this client.)

SECTION 4 - About the Event

21. Provide a detailed case study of the event highlighting your significant achievements. Include details on the following, to ensure you address the Judging Criteria
 - a. The benefits provided to stakeholders
 - b. The event communication and promotion campaign
 - c. Any innovative, unique or creative elements
 - d. The complexity of the event - any challenges faced in achieving the outcomes and how they were overcome. (*Challenges might be budget, human resources, expertise, technology, weather, time, safety, stakeholder relations, scale, positioning*)
 - e. Ways in which the event demonstrated commitment to best practices. For example, address your commitment to corporate social responsibility (CSR), sustainability, equality, use of technology and/or legacy.
 - f. Evidence substantiating any claims you make. (*Evidence may include statistics, extracts from press articles, quotes from stakeholders including suppliers or attendees, and results from post event surveys or external evaluations.*)

Word Limit: 2150 words.

22. Describe how the event achieved and advanced the aims of the organising body. Include examples of outstanding communication and how it encouraged relationship building and delivered an outstanding experience for attendees. *Word Limit: 450 words.*
23. Upload a testimonial from your client or, if you did not have a client, a testimonial from your sponsor or event attendees. (*If you have more than one testimonial, please upload all testimonials collated into a single PDF document. Maximum limit of 5x A4 pages total. Persons providing testimonials should be prepared to be contacted by the judging panel for further information if required.*)

Should your entry be announced as the National Winner at the Event Awards Ceremony, a summary of the event will be announced.

24. Please provide a brief summary including:
 - a. Description of what the event is
 - b. What was outstanding about the event
 - c. How it met and delivered an outstanding experience for the attendees

Word Limit: 100 words.

Entrant Acknowledgement and Media Information

Entries will be highlighted on our social media and if this entry becomes a National Nominee and/or Winner, we will promote it on our website, through our media partners and PR agency.

25. Provide one or two paragraphs about the event written in media-release style. *(This information may be used to showcase your achievements, promote your National Nominee status and used during and after the Awards Ceremony. This information may also be provided directly to media outlets.)*

To assist us to showcase your achievements on our social media, submit: (Note that images and videos may also be provided to media outlets and used at the Event Awards Ceremony and after the Ceremony.)

26. **EITHER:** Submit a high-res photograph *(File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
27. **OR:** A video (maximum 15 seconds) Video must be in MP4 format, no larger than 29MB. Must be one of the following sizes:
Square (W:1080px X H: 1080px)
Horizontal (W:1080px X H:608px)
Vertical (W:1080 x H:1350px)
The video could depict a moment from your event, achievement, innovation or product being used, yourself talking about the event/product, a video of your team hard at work, etc.
NOTE: Images or videos that do not meet the required specifications provided may result in the image or video not being usable on social media.
28. Provide a caption (including names of people) and a description of the photo or video provided above.
29. Please provide the names of the team you would like to acknowledge, and up to three Facebook social media handles - these social media handles will be used when recognising the entrant. *(We like to mention the people who make the event happen in our promotion of the entrants. Information may also be provided to media outlets.)*
30. **OPT OUT:** I do not wish to have my entry highlighted or showcased on your social media.

Entry Submission

31. This entry is complete and ready for Judging